

FREE PROMPT PACK

Date Through *the Decades*: the prompts

Every prompt I used to get ready for the same first date in 1888, 1925, 1943, 1977, 1996 and today, with the same mirror, the same face and a very modern ending. Copy, paste, swap in your own look.

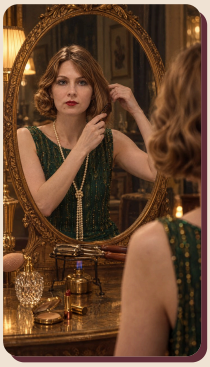
BY WOMEN LEAD AI · WOMENLEAD.AI

BEFORE YOU START

One date, *six decades*

The idea is simple: the same woman gets ready for a first date in six different decades, each with the beauty ritual of its time. A maid laces a corset, Marcel waves come off a hot iron, a stocking seam is drawn on with eyebrow pencil, hair gets blow dried upside down, a disposable camera flashes in the mirror. Then, today, the phone buzzes and the date cancels by text.

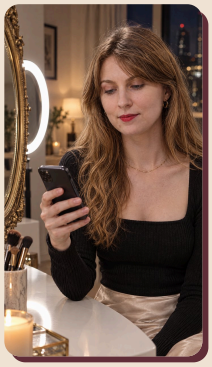

1888


1925


1943


1977


1996


Today

WHAT YOU NEED

- **A Higgsfield account.** Character sheets and first frames cost about 3 credits each. An 8 second Seedance 2.5 clip at 1080p costs 128 credits. My whole video came to about 900 credits, roughly $54, including a few redos.
- **2 or 3 clear photos of your face.** One straight on, one three quarter, natural light, no filters.
- **Claude Code with the Higgsfield connector**, to write the prompts, run the jobs, keep track of every job ID and stitch the final video. It also does the finishing touches on page 11.

THE FOUR STEPS

1. **Dress for each decade:** one character sheet per era, so your face and outfit stay locked.
2. **Set the first frame:** one still per era at the same antique mirror, so you see the shot before you pay for video.
3. **Animate each ritual** in Seedance 2.5, one clip at a time.
4. **Finish it** with trims, a decade counter, the text message and your song.

Go to Higgsfield here: higgsfield.ai

Step 1

A sheet for *every decade*

In Higgsfield go to Images, pick **GPT Image 2.5**, quality high, 2K, aspect ratio **16:9**, and add your 3 face photos as references. Generate one image at a time and check it before moving on.

```
Character reference sheet of the woman in the reference photos, dressed as [WHO, WHERE, WHEN, e.g. a young London woman getting ready for an evening out in 1925]. Keep her face EXACTLY as in the photos: [EYES], [ONE DISTINCTIVE DETAIL, e.g. a beauty mark], natural skin with real texture, [MAKEUP FOR THE ERA]. Do not beautify, slim or change her face in any way.
Costume, historically accurate for [PLACE AND YEAR], in [ERA COLOURS]: [OUTFIT LINE]. Hair: her own [HAIR COLOUR] hair [STYLE FOR THE ERA].
Layout on a plain warm light grey studio background: on the left a large close-up portrait facing camera; in the middle a full-length front view standing naturally; then a full-length side view and a full-length back view. Soft even studio light, photorealistic photography, natural proportions, real fabric texture. Calm, friendly expression. No text, no labels, no logos, no watermark.
```



Show what the scene needs. My 1888 sheet is half dressed on purpose, so the back view shows the corset laces the maid pulls in the video. My 1943 sheet shows the pencilled seam on the back of the calf.

Step 1

My 1888 sheet, *word for word*

```
Photorealistic historical costume character reference sheet, London 1888. The reference photos show
the woman, whose face must be an exact match in EVERY panel: soft oval face, blue-grey eyes, straight
nose, natural full lips, small beauty mark below the lower lip on the right side, fair skin with faint
freckles, light honey-brown hair. About 168 cm tall, 7.5 heads tall, slim natural build. Do not
beautify, do not age up.
Four panels side by side on a plain light grey seamless studio background: far left a tight chest-up
face close-up looking at camera; then a full-body front view; then a full-body three-quarter view
turned to the right with the face clearly visible; then a full-body back view. Frame the full-body
panels tightly, head to boots, faces large and sharp.
She is half dressed for an evening out, in modest, historically accurate late Victorian undergarments,
identical in every panel: a white cotton chemise with short puffed sleeves and a high scooped neckline
trimmed with fine broderie lace, fully covering the chest and shoulders; over it an ivory sateen
corset with visible boning channels, a straight front steel busk with small hooks, and long white
cotton laces criss-crossed up the back, the laces loosely tied and trailing, clearly visible in the
back view; a full white cotton petticoat with three ruffled tiers at the hem over a small bustle pad
at the back, reaching the ankles; white cotton stockings and black leather button boots. Hair in a
period style: a high soft twisted bun on the crown, with a short curled fringe across the forehead, a
few loose wisps at the nape. No jewellery except tiny gold stud earrings.
No makeup, natural bare lips, a faint natural flush on the cheeks. Calm, friendly expression, natural
skin texture, no retouching, soft even studio light, cinematic realism. Single subject only, no text,
no watermark.
```

MY SIX LOOKS, READY TO PASTE

ERA	OUTFIT LINE	HAIR AND MAKEUP
1888	white lace chemise, ivory sateen corset laced at the back, white ruffled petticoat, button boots	high twisted bun, soft curled fringe, bare lips
1925	jade green silk chiffon drop waist dress with gold and green beads, long knotted rope of pearls, gold T bar shoes	chin length bob with Marcel waves, berry cupid's bow lips, kohl eyes
1943	navy rayon tea dress with white polka dots, white collar, red brooch, bare legs with tan leg makeup and a pencilled seam, red peep toes	victory rolls, bold matte red lipstick
1977	burnt orange, brown and cream geometric jersey wrap dress, gold chain, gold hoops, suede platform sandals	feathered Farrah flicks, bronzed cheeks, frosted peach gloss
1996	lilac satin slip dress over a white baby tee, black tattoo choker, platform Mary Janes with white socks, an unbranded disposable camera	straight with pastel butterfly clips, brown lip liner and gloss
Today	black ribbed square neck top, champagne satin midi skirt, gold hoops and chain, black kitten heels, phone in hand	long loose waves, curtain bangs, classic red lip

Step 2

The same *mirror*, every time

Same model, **GPT Image 2.5**, quality high, 2K, but **9:16**. References: the era sheet first, then 2 face photos. One antique oval mirror in a carved gilt frame appears in every decade: it is the thread that ties the whole video together.

- **Show the whole mirror.** Say "a clear mirror shot" and "the WHOLE oval mirror fully visible". Otherwise you get one gilt edge and no reflection.
- **Your real body must match your reflection.** If your arm is raised in the mirror, your foreground shoulder rises too. Write it into the prompt now and again in the video prompt.
- **Keep tools out of your hands** in the first frame where you can. My curling tongs looked fused to my hand until I rested them on a stand over the flame.

My 1925 frame, *word for word*



```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic, the first frame of a video.
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face
from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face with blue-grey eyes, not
beautified, wearing exactly the costume from the sheet: jade green beaded
drop-waist dress, long knotted rope of pearls, red cupid's bow lips, dark
kohl eyes. ONLY she has this face.
SCENE: a London flat in 1925, evening, getting ready for a first date at a
dance hall. She sits at an Art Deco dressing table facing an antique oval
mirror in a carved gilt frame. Her honey-brown hair is a CHIN-LENGTH bob on
both sides, no longer than the jaw: the left side already set in glossy
Marcel waves, the right side still straight and plain. Her hands are empty
of tools: with her left hand she lifts a small section of the straight
side, and with her right hand she holds a small tortoiseshell comb against
it. On the table in front of the mirror, a pair of steel Marcel waving
tongs with wooden handles rests on a small iron warming stand above the
blue flame of a brass spirit lamp, clearly a separate object, not touching
her. Also on the table: a powder compact, a lipstick, a cut-glass perfume
atomiser.
CAMERA: a clear mirror shot. The camera is behind her and slightly to her
right, over her shoulder: in the foreground the back of her head and her
bare shoulder, soft and out of focus; in the middle of the frame the WHOLE
oval mirror with its carved gilt frame fully visible on all sides, and
inside the mirror her reflection, sharp, showing her face, the dress and
the pearls, her eyes on her own reflection. It must be obvious that we are
looking at a reflection in a mirror. Warm golden lamp light, soft haze,
35mm film look, fine grain, natural skin texture, five fingers on each
hand. No text, no watermark.
```

Step 2

1888, *laced in by the maid*



```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic, the first frame of a video.
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face
from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified, wearing
exactly the costume from the sheet: white lace-trimmed chemise, ivory
sateen corset with loose white laces at the back, white ruffled petticoat,
hair in a high twisted bun with a soft fringe, bare lips. ONLY she has this
face.
SCENE: a London bedroom on a winter evening in 1888, getting ready for a
first date. She stands at a mahogany dressing table in front of an antique
oval mirror in a carved gilt frame, both hands braced on the table edge.
Behind her, a lady's maid (a clearly different, older woman with grey hair
under a white cap, black dress and white apron) grips the corset laces in
both fists, about to pull them tight; the maid is half turned away and
slightly out of focus. On the dressing table: a hairbrush, hairpins, a
small glass scent bottle, an oil lamp glowing. Flowered wallpaper, heavy
velvet curtains.
CAMERA: three-quarter angle from beside the mirror, waist-up, her face
clearly visible and sharp, her eyes on her own reflection in the oval
mirror, not looking at the camera. Warm amber oil lamp light, deep shadows,
35mm film look, fine grain, shallow depth of field, natural skin texture,
five fingers. No text, no watermark.
```

1943, *no nylons, draw the seam*



```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic, the first frame of a video.
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face
from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified, wearing
exactly the costume from the sheet: navy polka dot tea dress with white
collar and red brooch, victory rolls, red lipstick, bare painted legs, red
peep-toe shoes. ONLY she has this face.
SCENE: a small London bedroom in 1943, evening, getting ready for a
Saturday night dance. Blackout curtains drawn, a wooden wireless radio on
the dressing table, a small jar of tan leg makeup open beside it. She
stands beside the dressing table with one foot up on a wooden chair,
twisting to look over her shoulder at the back of her calf in an antique
oval mirror in a carved gilt frame. In her hand an eyebrow pencil touches
the back of her heel, about to draw the seam line up her bare leg; no line
drawn yet.
CAMERA: three-quarter angle from beside the mirror, full figure from head
to shoe, her face clearly visible and sharp over her shoulder, her eyes on
her reflection, not looking at the camera. Warm low lamp light, 35mm film
look, fine grain, slightly muted wartime colour, natural skin texture, five
fingers. No flags, no insignia, no text, no watermark.
```

Step 2

1977, *blow dry and hairspray*



```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic, the first frame of a video.
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face
from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified, wearing
exactly the costume from the sheet: burnt orange and brown geometric wrap
dress, gold hoops, gold chain, glossy peach lip. ONLY she has this face.
SCENE: a London bedroom in 1977, Saturday evening, getting ready for a
first date at the disco. Orange and brown patterned wallpaper, a record
player with a vinyl spinning, a lava lamp. She sits at a dressing table in
front of an antique oval mirror in a carved gilt frame, holding a cream
plastic 1970s hand-held hair dryer with no brand in one hand and a round
bristle brush in the other, rolling a section of her shoulder-length honey-
brown hair back away from her face into a big feathered flick. A tall can
of hairspray with no readable label stands on the table.
CAMERA: three-quarter angle from beside the mirror, chest-up, her face
clearly visible and sharp, her eyes on her own reflection in the oval
mirror, not looking at the camera. Warm tungsten light with an orange glow,
slight haze, 35mm film look with 70s colour, fine grain, natural skin
texture, five fingers. No text, no watermark.
```

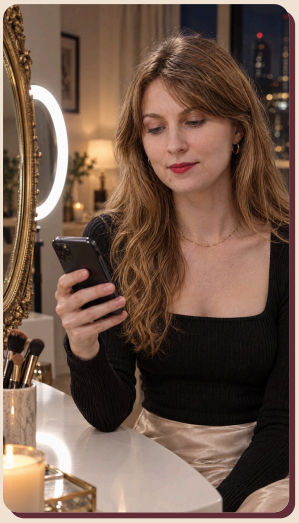
1996, *one flash on the disposable*



```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic, the first frame of a video.
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face
from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified, wearing
exactly the costume from the sheet: lilac satin slip dress over a white
baby tee, black tattoo choker, pastel butterfly clips, brown-lined glossy
lips. ONLY she has this face.
SCENE: a teenager-style London bedroom in 1996, evening, getting ready for
a first date. Fairy lights, posters on the wall with no readable text, a
cordless phone and a hair crimper on the dressing table, a CD player. She
stands in front of an antique oval mirror in a carved gilt frame on the
dressing table, holding a small plain cardboard disposable film camera with
no brand at chest height, her thumb on the film winder wheel, about to
raise it for a mirror photo.
CAMERA: three-quarter angle from beside the mirror, waist-up, her face
clearly visible and sharp, her eyes on her own reflection in the oval
mirror, not looking at the camera. Soft warm fairy light and a pink bedside
lamp, 35mm film look with 90s colour, fine grain, natural skin texture,
five fingers. No text, no logos, no watermark.
```

Step 2

Today, *one last check of the app*



```
Cinematic vertical film still, photorealistic, the first frame of a video.
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face
from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified, wearing
exactly the costume from the sheet: black ribbed square-neck top, champagne
satin midi skirt, thin gold hoops, red lip, long honey-brown waves with
curtain bangs. ONLY she has this face.
SCENE: a modern London flat in 2026, evening, ready for a first date. She
sits at a white dressing table in front of an antique oval mirror in a
carved gilt frame, a round LED ring light glowing beside it, makeup brushes
in a cup, a candle. Her makeup and hair are finished. She holds her
smartphone in her right hand, the screen facing her and NOT visible to the
camera, glancing down at it with a small hopeful smile.
CAMERA: three-quarter angle from beside the mirror, chest-up, her face
clearly visible and sharp, lit by the ring light, looking down at her
phone, not at the camera. Clean soft ring light with warm candle glow,
modern cinematic look, shallow depth of field, natural skin texture, five
fingers. No text, no logos, no watermark.
```

Keep the phone screen hidden. AI garbles app screens and text. The message gets added in the edit instead (page 11).

Step 3

Animate *each ritual*

In Higgsfield go to Video and pick **Seedance 2.5**. These are the exact settings I used for all six clips:

Mode	Reference (omni reference)
Start frame	your approved first frame from step 2
References	the era sheet first, then 2 face photos
Aspect ratio	9:16
Duration	8 seconds (you will trim most of them)
Resolution	1080p, 128 credits per clip
Audio	on, sound effects only: write "no music, no speech"

Step 3

The video prompt, *and my 1996 one*

```
Start exactly from the start frame. CHARACTER: the woman from the start frame, Reference Image 1
(character sheet) and the real photos, exactly this face in every frame, not beautified, wearing
exactly the costume from the sheet: [SHORT OUTFIT LINE]. ONLY she has this face.
MOMENT: [PLACE AND YEAR], getting ready for a first date.
SETTING: [ROOM, PROPS, THE ANTIQUE OVAL MIRROR].
ACTION: [THE RITUAL, STEP BY STEP, AND HOW SHE REACTS AT THE END].
MIRROR: [ONLY FOR MIRROR SHOTS: the foreground body moves in perfect sync with the reflection].
CAMERA: one continuous shot, [MOVE], 9:16 vertical, never cuts. Shot on 35mm, [LIGHT], fine grain,
photoreal, natural proportions, five fingers, no morphing.
AUDIO: [3 TO 5 SOUNDS FROM THE RITUAL], no music, no speech, no subtitles.
```

```
Start exactly from the start frame. CHARACTER: the woman from the start frame, Reference Image 1
(character sheet) and the real photos, exactly this face in every frame, not beautified, wearing
exactly the costume from the sheet: lilac satin slip dress over a white baby tee, black tattoo choker,
pastel butterfly clips, brown-lined glossy lips. ONLY she has this face.
MOMENT: London, an evening in 1996, getting ready for a first date.
SETTING: a bedroom with fairy lights, posters with no readable text, a pink lamp, a cordless phone, a
crimper and a Discman on the dressing table, an antique oval mirror in a carved gilt frame.
ACTION: she raises the small cardboard disposable camera with both hands up to her eye, aims it at the
mirror, and presses the button: a bright white flash pops and lights up the mirror. She lowers the
camera, winds the film on with her thumb with a click-click-click, flicks her hair over her shoulder
and gives her reflection a cheeky smile.
MIRROR: this is a mirror shot. In the foreground her own back, shoulders and both arms are visible and
soft; her reflection in the oval mirror is sharp. BOTH foreground arms hold and raise the camera
exactly as the reflection does, in perfect sync, in every frame; the foreground arms are visible and
never hang down while the reflection holds the camera. A true mirror, no mismatch.
CAMERA: one continuous shot over her shoulder towards the mirror, a very slow push in, 9:16 vertical,
never cuts. Shot on 35mm with 90s colour, soft warm fairy light and pink lamp glow, fine grain, real
hair physics, photoreal, natural proportions, five fingers, no morphing.
AUDIO: the click of the camera shutter, the pop of the flash, the ratchet click of the film wheel
winding, fabric rustle, a faint CD player hum, no music, no speech, no subtitles.
```

Render one clip, check it, then the next. Each takes 5 to 10 minutes. Check every half second for vanishing props, faces drifting and the reflection going out of sync before you spend another 128 credits.

Step 3

The other rituals, *word for word*

These are the ACTION lines from my other five video prompts. Drop each into the template on page 9.

1888

ACTION: the maid steps in behind her, braces and pulls the corset laces hard twice; with each pull the young woman's waist cinches in, she grips the table edge and lets out a small sharp gasp, her shoulders lifting. The maid ties the laces off and steps back out of focus. The young woman straightens, breathes out, leans towards the oval mirror and looks at her own reflection, then pinches both cheeks firmly with her fingertips; a soft rosy flush blooms on her cheeks, and she gives her reflection a small, satisfied, shy smile.

1925

ACTION: she puts the tortoiseshell comb down, lifts the hot Marcel tongs off the stand by their wooden handles, and clamps them onto the straight section of her bob just below the parting; a thin wisp of steam rises with a soft sizzle; she rolls the tongs a quarter turn, holds, then opens them and slides them out, leaving a glossy deep S-shaped wave that now matches the waves on the other side. She sets the tongs back on the stand, touches the new wave lightly with her fingertips, turns her head a little to admire both sides, and gives her reflection a confident, pleased smile. Her hair stays chin length throughout.

1943

ACTION: with her foot up on the wooden chair, she leans down and places the eyebrow pencil at the back of her heel, then carefully draws one thin, straight dark line up the back of her calf to just behind the knee, glancing over her shoulder into the mirror to keep it straight. She lowers her foot to the floor, turns her back towards the mirror and looks over her shoulder at the pencilled seam on her leg, then gives a small proud smile. The seam line stays thin, dark and straight once drawn.

1977

ACTION: she turns the cream hair dryer so it blows straight onto the round brush and rolls a section back into a feathered flick; then she flips her head upside down and blasts her hair from underneath with the dryer, hair flying; she flips her head back up and her hair lands in huge, bouncy, feathered Farrah flicks sweeping back from her face. She puts the dryer down, grabs the hairspray can and sprays a big glittering cloud of hairspray all around her head, squinting and waving the mist away with her hand, then grins at her reflection.

TODAY

ACTION: she glances down at her phone with a hopeful little smile, scrolls with her thumb; the phone buzzes in her hand with a new message; she reads it, and her smile slowly falls; she blinks, her shoulders drop, she lets out a long sigh, lowers the phone onto the table face down, and looks up at her own reflection in the oval mirror, fully dressed up with nowhere to go, with a wry, deflated half smile. The phone screen is never visible to the camera.

Step 4

Finish it in *Claude Code*

Everything on this page is done on your computer, no more credits. Paste these into Claude Code, swapping in your own times and words.

Cut the glitchy seconds

```
Cut the 1925 clip at 5 seconds, the brush disappears after that. Keep the original file and save the trimmed one as edit.mp4.
```

Strip the music, keep the movement

```
Seedance added background music to the 1940s clip. Split the sound into stems with Demucs, remove only the sustained musical notes, and keep my movement sounds: the rustling, the chair and the pencil. Lift them so they are audible, with a limiter so nothing clips.
```

Show the text message

```
Add a chat bubble to the last clip when the phone buzzes: typing dots first, then a grey bubble from James with a small pink heart app icon that says "So sorry, something's come up tonight 😬 Can we do another time?". Keep it off my face and above the Instagram caption area.
```

Add the rolling decade counter

```
Stitch the six clips in order and add a rolling decade counter: the current decade big in the centre, the previous one small above and the next one small below, rolling up one notch at every cut with a soft flick sound. Move it in each clip so it never covers my face or the action.
```

Add the intro

```
Over the first 3 seconds add "prepping for a" in bold white, "DATE" huge underneath and "through the decades" in a cream serif italic, each line rising in with a fade over a soft dark gradient.
```



The rolling decade counter



The message, added in the edit

From my redos

Six fixes that *saved me credits*

1. **My reflection didn't match me.** In one frame my reflection faced the camera while I stood side on. Add a MIRROR line to every mirror shot: the real body and the reflection move in perfect sync.
2. **My curling tongs turned electric.** The video gave my 1920s Marcel iron a cable, even though it was heating on a flame. Ask for "a cordless iron, no cable".
3. **A prop vanished halfway.** My comb disappeared after 5 seconds. Trim the clip there instead of paying for a new one.
4. **I smiled at the wrong moment.** The cancellation clip ended with a smile creeping in. Cut the last second rather than re-render.
5. **"No music" still came with music.** Two clips had a soundtrack anyway. Strip it with stems (page 11) so your own song sits on top.
6. **I rendered everything at once.** I batched all six first frames and then redid two. Approve one frame, then make the next.

MORE RITUALS TO TRY

The 1960s: false lashes and a beehive. The 1980s: crimped hair, teased roots and a whole can of hairspray. The 2000s: hair straighteners, a flip phone and huge lip gloss. Or swap the date for a job interview, a wedding or a night out.

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